Writing: Life used to be different

Day 2 · Writing

What to do: Discuss first (exercise 1), then write in the copybook at home or in class.

Murphy today
Murphy red, Unit 36 (page 83): **36.3** at home. Do the grammar file first.

1 Warm-up: talk before you write (5 minutes, in pairs)

1. Ask a grandparent or an older person: what did life use to be like when they were young?
2. What did people use to do for fun when there was no TV or internet?
3. How did children use to go to school?
4. What did people use to eat? What didn't they use to eat?
5. What did the town or village use to look like?
6. Which things were better in the past? Which are better now?
7. What did YOU use to do when you were five?
8. What do you miss most from your childhood?

Choose one topic and tell it to your partner. The partner asks one more question for each of the first 3 answers.

2 Useful words

Used to · didn't use to · but now · no longer · any more · in those days · when I was a child

Unit 6 words: community · weather · distance · choice · return · wise · survive · pet

3 The plan: 4 short paragraphs, 120–150 words

1 · Introduction	Whose life are you writing about? When? (a grandparent, or you)
2 · Body 1	What did people use to do? Give 3 examples with used to.
3 · Body 2	What didn't they use to have or do? What is different now?
4 · Conclusion	Which life do you prefer? Why?

Model and your task

Day 2 · Writing

What to do: In the model: used to for habits, past simple for single events.

My Grandmother's Village

My grandmother grew up in a small village near Bukhara. When she was a child, life was very different from life today. She used to walk three kilometers to school every day, in all kinds of weather.

The village community used to be very close. People used to help each other with the harvest, and in the evening everybody used to sit together and listen to stories. Her grandfather was wise: he used to tell the children about the stars.

She didn't use to have a phone or a TV. But she says she was never bored. Now the village has internet and a new road. My grandmother loves her phone, but she no longer knows all her neighbors. I think the old life was slower, and maybe better.

A Choose ONE: life used to be different

Write 120–150 words. Follow the plan. Use used to at least 5 times, didn't use to at least 2 times, but now / any more, and 4 words from Unit 6.

B Or: an email to a friend

Write 100–120 words. *Hi ..., Yesterday I talked to my grandfather. He told me that he used to ... He didn't use to ... Now ...*

Check before you finish

4 paragraphs · used to / didn't use to (not "use to" in positives) · but now · 4 Unit 6 words · capital letters and full stops